

If love ever finds you, it won't knock loud enough to scare your ghosts back into hiding, it will sit beside your noise until even your silence forgets it was ever dividing.

You'll notice it in the small things first, how your name sounds different leaving their mouth at night, not heavier with expectation, just softer somehow, like it finally learned how to land right.

There is a quiet gravity to that softness. For so long, your name was something shouted in anger or whispered in negotiation, a currency spent to buy a moment of peace.

But the way they say it feels like a sanctuary, a steady weight that anchors you to the floor when your thoughts try to pull you into the stratosphere.

It is the sudden, breathless realization that someone can hold your entire history in the palm of their hand without crushing it.

There's something unsettling about not having to decode every pause or unfinished reply, no sharp edges hidden in kindness, no need to translate affection or question why.

Your body won't brace for impact when they get too close or say something dangerously kind, and that alone will terrify you more than all the chaos you've previously defined.

It is a terrifying kind of romance, the kind that makes the blood rush to your ears because there is no enemy to fight. When you are built for warfare, peace feels like an ambush.

You watch them across the room, watching the effortless way they move toward you, and your soul reaches for weapons that are no longer there.

The intensity isn't in a screaming match or a grand, dramatic gesture; it is in the quiet, agonizing surrender of letting down your guard, millimeter by millimeter, while they watch you thaw with eyes that promise they aren't going anywhere.

Because you were fluent in almost-love, in almost-stay, in reading between lines that cut deep, and now there's nothing to solve, nothing to chase, nothing slipping away while you sleep.

They won't love you like a fire that consumes just to prove it was ever alive, more like something embarrassingly gentle, like they simply wake up every day and decide.

Decide you, without spectacle, without turning care into performance or staying into art, just a quiet choosing that doesn't ask you to break yourself apart.

And then there's you, the one standing there offering something real without even realizing its weight, thinking consistency is simple, thinking love should never hesitate or negotiate its state.

You stand there, holding the heavy, unvarnished truth of who you are, terrified that the moment they look too closely, the illusion will shatter.

But they don't just look; they study you. They map the jagged lines of your defenses, the sharp corners of your pride, and the quiet, desperate way you hold your breath when you're overwhelmed.

And instead of stepping back, they step directly into your space, pulling you into an embrace so fierce and deliberate it leaves no room for the ghosts to breathe. It is a slow, burning devotion that doesn't demand your perfection, only your presence.

So let me tell you gently, so you understand what your presence has been doing to me, you've been showing me what it means to be chosen without conditions, without urgency.

You've been patient in ways I wasn't used to receiving, steady in ways I didn't expect to feel, you've made silence safe again, made closeness feel real.

You didn't arrive like chaos pretending to be passion, you didn't turn care into a test, you didn't make me decode every moment just to guess what comes next.

You simply stayed present, even when nothing dramatic was happening to hold your attention, you loved without turning it into a performance, without needing constant validation or mention.

And that is what unsettled me at first, not your distance, but your clarity, because I was used to love arriving with confusion, not clarity. You didn't make me earn warmth, or chase down

affection that should have already been mine, you just placed it in my hands like it was always meant to align.

It is the alignment that takes the breath from my lungs. It is the way your hand finds mine in the dark, not to pull me anywhere, but simply to remind me that I am not alone in the room.

There is an intoxication in this kind of safety. It makes me want to give you every hidden piece of me, the parts I thought were too loud, too heavy, too fiercely guarded for anyone to ever love.

You look at my ruins and you see a home. You take the fiercely independent anchor I have always had to be for everyone else, and you gently whisper that it is okay to let go, that you are strong enough to hold the line.

So if I seem quiet in it, if I sometimes look like I don't know how to receive something so steady and true, it's only because I'm learning what it means to be loved without losing pieces of myself in the view.

And somewhere between the absence of fear and the presence of something steady and true, I'm learning to stop grieving the love that hurt me... and start trusting the one that's coming through you.

Not every beautiful thing arrives loudly, some feel like unfamiliar air in your chest, and healthy love, strangely enough, might be the scariest thing you've ever trusted to be best.

But as I breathe in this unfamiliar air, I realize I don't want to go back to the oxygen that was burning me alive. If this steady, beautiful thing we are building is a risk, then let it consume me. Because for the first time in my life, I am not fighting to survive love, I am finally living in it.